BY ORDER OF THE COMMANDER
374TH AIRLIFT WING

YOKOTA AIR BASE INSTRUCTION
34-101
22 JULY 2026

Services

CONTROL, CARE, AND IMMUNIZATION OF PETS

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS INSTRUCTION IS MANDATORY

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(Colonel Burt N. Okamoto)

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This instruction assigns responsibilities and establishes procedures for the control, care, and immunization of pets in accordance with Air Force Instruction (AFI) 32-6000, *Housing Management.* This instruction applies to all personnel and organizations assigned to Yokota Air Base (AB). This instruction requires the collection and maintenance of information protected by the Privacy Act of 1974 authorized by Title 10 United States Code (U.S.C.) 3013, *Secretary of the Army;* 10 U.S.C. 5013, *Secretary of the Navy;* 10 U.S.C. 8013, *Secretary of the Air Force;* Department of Defense Directive (DoDD) 6400.5, *DoD Veterinary Public and Animal Health Services Program;* Army Regulation (AR) 40-905, Secretary of the Navy Instruction (SECNAVIST) 6401.1B, Air Force Instruction (AFI) 48-131, *Veterinary Health Services.* Refer recommended changes and questions about this publication to the office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) using the AF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication.* Route AF Form 847 through the appropriate chain of command. Ensure that all records created as a result of processes prescribed in this publication are maintained in accordance with Air Force Manual 33-363, *Management of Records,* and disposed of in accordance with the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule located in the air force Records Information Management System.

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

Clarified the responsibilities of Civil Engineer Squadron (CES), Pet Boarding and the Veterinary Clinic pertaining to stray animals found on base during normal duty hours and outside of normal duty hours. Outlined the Veterinary Clinic responsibilities for screening strays. Delineated CES responsibilities for capturing strays reported to the CES Customer Service Desk and transport

requirements. Outlined Pet Boarding roles in housing overnight if/when CES cannot contact the owner by close of business. Clarified Pet Boarding responsibilities for all suspected abuse or neglect cases. Better defined what types of animals are allowed as pets. Added definitions for aggressive, dangerous, and vicious animal behavior as well as abandonment, abuse and neglect.

1. Terms Explained. See Attachment 1.

2. Responsibilities Assigned.

2.1. Animal owners and persons with custody of animals will:

2.1.1. Ensure pets are properly registered and scheduled for micro chipping at the veterinary treatment facility within three working days of arrival or purchase, scheduled to receive required immunizations, and always wear the issued identification tag. Receiving a micro chip and immunizations may not be possible within three working days of arrival or purchase, but scheduling these actions must be accomplished within that period.

2.1.2. Deregister any animal leaving the country from Veterinary Services.

2.1.3. Re-register pets with new owner information when there is a change of ownership.

2.1.4. Not introduce or maintain any animal onto the installation which is showing a vicious or dangerous nature.

2.1.5. Maintain no more than two pets per household (this restriction applies only to dogs, cats, and rabbits).

2.1.6. Only maintain approved animals. The following animals are not approved to be maintained on the installation: Birds, reptiles, rodents (other than hamsters and guinea pigs), ferrets, hedgehogs, skunks, rats, raccoons, squirrels, potbellied pigs, monkeys, arachnids, any farm animal, and amphibians.

2.1.7. Maintain aquariums up to, a combined, 50 gallons for fish and will not flush or release fish into the waterways or sewer systems.

2.1.8. Treat and maintain all animals in humane conditions with adequate food, water, shelter, living space, and veterinary care.

2.1.9. No intentional breeding of animals.

2.1.10. No profiting of or selling animals for monetary or commercial gains excluding those pets sold, if required, for Permanent Change of Station (PCS) or change in residency.

2.1.11. Adhere to animal bite quarantine requirements (if applicable) to include attending initial evaluation appointment at the Yokota Veterinary Clinic, confinement of the animal for 10 days after the bite occurs and attending final veterinarian evaluation appointment at the Yokota Veterinary Clinic.

2.1.12. All personnel residing off-base who must bring a pet on base for any reason (emergency evacuation, veterinary services, use of dog parks) will adhere to the requirements in this instruction in addition to complying with any local pet ordinances and laws at their residency location.

2.1.13. Animal owners whose animal is placed under quarantine will ensure their animal attends all required appointments with a Military Veterinarian at their scheduled date and time. Schedule adjustments must be reported immediately and no later than 24 hours in advance.

2.2. Veterinary Services will:

2.2.1. Advise the 374th Airlift Wing Commander (374 AW/CC) or the designee on pet neglect cases, vicious pets, and the pet disease control program, as well as administer required immunizations to pets and issue rabies identification tags.

2.2.2. Veterinary Services will forward all cases involving repeated actual or attempted scratches, bites, or attacks by a pet to 374 AW/CC or the designee for determination on whether to remove the animal from the installation.

2.2.3. As their primary mission, provide services for the military working dogs.

2.2.4. See to privately owned animals on an as needed basis.

2.2.5. Provide written quarantine instructions to owners as needed.

2.2.6. Assist base officials in determining the need, and recommended method, for disposal of any animal believed to be a danger to the public.

2.2.7. Implant microchips for permanent identification and maintain a database of all registered animals.

2.2.8. Have the authority to euthanize animals that must be disposed of in accordance with applicable regulations, including AFI 48-131.

2.2.9. Screen for microchips during normal business hours to determine and contact the owner of all stray animals captured by CES. If the owner is not responsive, the pet will be turned over to Pet Boarding for short term boarding based on space available. The Pet Care Center will return the pet to CES by close of business if kennel space is unavailable.

2.2.10. Euthanize captured animals deemed feral and uncontrollable by the Veterinary Clinic.

2.3. 374 CES Entomology/Pest Control will:

2.3.1. Dispose of animal carcasses found on installation on a 24-hour basis.

2.3.2. Capture all stray animals found on the installation. During normal business hours, stray pets should be reported to the CES customer service desk for relay to 374 CES Entomology/Pest Control. Outside of normal business hours, stray pets should be reported to installation emergency services for relay to 374 CES Entomology/Pest Control.

2.3.3. Transport all captured stray animals to the Yokota Veterinary Clinic for microchip screening.

2.3.4. Control animals deemed to be aggressive, dangerous, and/or vicious, and transport them to the Yokota Veterinary Clinic for disposition.

2.4. The Yokota Pet Care Center (374th Force Support Squadron) will:

2.4.1. Assist CES with caring for cats and dogs by housing strays overnight if the owner is unreachable. The Pet Care Center will return the pet to CES by close of business if kennel space is unavailable.

2.4.2. Yokota Pet Care Center will advise Security Forces of all suspected pet abuse or neglect cases.

2.5. The 374th Security Forces Squadron (SFS) will:

2.5.1. Receive complaints and maintain administrative records of incidents and complaints involving pets and forward an incident report to the owner's commander when an owner violates this instruction.

2.5.2. Complete an initial entry in the daily blotters on captured animals by Security Forces.

2.6. The 374th Medical Group (MDG) will:

2.6.1. Immediately report any aggressive, dangerous, or vicious animal bite/scratch incidents to 374 SFS and the Yokota Veterinary Clinic.

2.6.2. Initiate a DD Form 2341, *Report of Animal Bite/Scratch-Potential Rabies Exposure*, IAW AFMAN 48-105, *Public Health Surveillance*, for all SOFA status personnel who have been bitten or scratched and presented at the MTF for treatment.

2.6.3. Veterinary Service personnel will examine the animal and institute applicable quarantine measures IAW AFI 48-131.

2.6.4. Encourage non-SOFA status and local national personnel to visit their physician for appropriate care.

3. Control of Pets:

3.1. Animals on quarantine are not allowed to leave the installation until released by the Yokota Veterinary Treatment Facility.

3.2. Pets may be taken to an outside area if owners exercise control IAW the definition provided in **Attachment 1**.

3.3. Owners must remove and dispose of feces left by their pets and ensure pets do not cause a nuisance.

3.4. Pets maintained off base are controlled per Japanese laws (check with the Japanese Public Health Office [Hokenjo] in your area). *Failure to comply with local laws may lead to legal action by Japanese law enforcement*.

3.5. Pet owners contact 374 CES Housing Office for instructions pertaining to pets in base housing.

3.6. No outside quarters will be built or maintained for pets without permission of the 374 CES Housing Office and the Base Veterinarian. To obtain permission, use AF Form 332, *Base Civil Engineer Work Request*. The form is self-explanatory.

3.7. All costs resulting from damage, destruction, injury, care, billeting, euthanasia, or removal of pets will be incurred by the owner.

4. Registration and Deregistration of Pets. Pets requiring registration (**Attachment 1**) will be registered with Veterinary Services. Registration for dogs and cats includes permanent identification with an implanted microchip, (microchipping). Registration only (no microchip) is required for rabbits. Veterinary Services will implant microchips at the owner's expense. A database of all pet microchipping will be maintained by the Veterinary Services Office.

5. Immunization of Pets: All dogs and cats, 91 days of age or older, must maintain current immunization against rabies. Those showing proof of immunization within the prescribed time intervals are exempt from receiving a new immunization at the time of arrival. A current valid DD Form 2208, *Rabies Vaccination Certificate,* or **signed original in blue ink** civilian-equivalent rabies vaccination form, must be presented to Veterinary Services and uploaded to that animal's official military health record.

5.1. Core vaccines protect against highly communicable diseases shared between pets and pose the highest risk of pet mortality. All dogs will receive the following core vaccines:

5.1.1. Rabies: annually.

5.1.2. Distemper/Parvo: every three years after initial vaccination or initial puppy series.

5.2. All cats will receive the following core vaccines every three years after initial vaccination or initial kitten series:

5.2.1. Rabies (unless more frequent immunization is directed by the 374 AW/CC in consultation with the Base Veterinarian).

5.2.2. FVRCP (parental, live attenuated).

5.2.3. FVP (feline panleukopenia virus).

5.2.4. FHV (feline hypesvirus-1).

5.2.5. FCV (feline calicivirus).

5.3. Current distemper and bordatella immunizations are also required to access on-base lodging and the Yokota Pet Care Center.

6. Removal of Pets from the Installation. The 374 AW/CC or designee may direct temporary or permanent removal of pets from the installation when:

6.1. The owner fails to have required pets immunized, registered, or microchipped.

6.2. The pet is not under control.

6.3. The pet exhibits excessive or continual nuisance behaviors as defined in **Attachment 1**.

6.4. The pet destroys government or private property, causes injury to humans or other pets, or has been taken into custody more than twice.

6.5. The pet is determined to be vicious or dangerous. **Note:** In any reported incident in which a pet attempts to or does scratch, bite, or attack a person or another pet, the Base Veterinarian will carefully review all circumstances before deciding whether to advise 374 AW/CC or the designee to have the pet permanently removed from the installation.

7. Disposition of Animals Determined to be Vicious or Dangerous.

7.1. The Base Veterinarian will carefully review all circumstances of reported aggressive, vicious, or dangerous animal behavior (**Attachment 1**) and reported cases in which the animal bites, scratches, or attacks another person or animal. **Note:** An animal does not have to scratch, bite or attack a person or another animal to be declared vicious or dangerous. A pet may exhibit or develop an ill temper or dangerous nature precluding the animal from being able to remain on Yokota Air Base.

7.2. If an animal is determined to be vicious or dangerous, the Base Veterinarian will advise the 374 AW/CC on a spectrum of dispositions to include, but not limited to:

7.2.1. Always required muzzling when outside of the domicile.

7.2.2. Treatment for behavioral disorders at the Yokota Veterinary Clinic or off-base veterinary clinic recommended by the Yokota Veterinary Clinic.

7.2.3. Transfer to an off-base shelter or animal welfare organization.

7.2.4. Transfer to an associate of the owner (e.g., family member, friend, acquaintance) in the United States at the animal owner or recipient's expense. The designated recipient of the animal will be informed of the animal's behavior and agree in writing to accept the animal and associated risks.

7.2.5. Transfer to a shelter or animal welfare organization in the United States.

7.2.6. Euthanasia.

7.2.7. Removal of pet privileges for the owner.

RICHARD.F MCELHANEY, Colonel, USAF
Commander

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, 23 March 2020
AFMAN 48-105, *Public Health Surveillance*, 11 October 2023

AFI 48-131, *Veterinary Health Services*, 28 February 2018

AR 40-905, *Veterinary Health Services,* 29 August 2006 Japanese Rabies Prevention Law

YOKOTA Air Base Pamphlet 32-1098, *Housing Management,* 10 May 2023

Adopted Form

AF Form 332, *Base Civil Engineer Work Request*

DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*

DD Form 2208, *Rabies Vaccination Certificate*

DD Form 2341, *Report of Animal Bite - Potential Rabies Exposure*

Terms

Abandonment—Covered under the UCMJ Article 134 (Animal Abuse), refers to intentionally, knowingly, recklessly, or negligently leaving an animal at a location without providing the necessary care, even though the person had charge or custody of the animal.

Abuse—Covered under the UCMJ Article 134 (Animal Abuse), refers to intentionally and unjustifiably overdriving, overloading, overworking, tormenting, beating, depriving of necessary sustenance, allowing to be housed in a manner that results in chronic or repeated severe physical harm, carrying or confining in or upon any vehicles cruelly or recklessly, or otherwise mistreating an animal. Abuse may also include any sexual touching of an animal not included in the definition of a sexual act with an animal.

Aggressive Animal Behavior—Refers to any of the types of following behaviors: 1) unprovoked barking, growling or snarling at people approaching the animal, 2) aggressively running along a fence line when people are present, 3) biting or scratching people, 4) attacking other pets, and 5) escaping confinement or restriction to chase people.

Control—Acts of owners to regulate pet behavior to prevent public nuisance. In case of all pets, the word "attended" means:

Dogs are always restrained outdoors by a leash under the control of an adult or youth, old enough and strong enough to control the pet. The leash must be strong enough to control the dog, or it must be in an approved fenced area, meeting base requirements.

Owners of cats are responsible for their pets' actions both indoors and outdoors. Although cats are not required to be leashed, they are not to be allowed to roam freely.
Rabbits, if taken outside, must be restrained by leash or in an approved fenced area. The fenced area must be adequate to contain the animal to prevent escape from gaps in fencing.
All pet owners are responsible for their pet's actions whether indoors or outdoors.

Dangerous Animal Behavior—Refers to any of the types of following behaviors: 1) acting in a way that makes a person reasonably believe they are in danger of serious injury, even if no injury occurs, 2) aggressively chasing or approaching a person in a menacing way, 3) unprovoked attacks or killing of other domestic animals, and 4) exhibiting signs of aggression such as growling, baring teeth, snarling, lunging, snapping, biting, and baring the whites of their eyes.

Microchipping—A procedure to insert a small microchip under the skin between the shoulder blades. Mandatory for dogs and cats. The microchip is then read by scanner to obtain identification.

Neglect—Covered under the UCMJ Article 134 (Animal Abuse), refers to knowingly allowing another to abuse an animal or failing to provide proper food, water, and shelter while in charge or custody of an animal.

Nuisance—Any occasion where a pet causes annoyance, inconvenience, injury, or discomfort to persons other than its owner.

Owner—A person legally possessing a pet or one who provides for its welfare, although not having legal ownership. Ownership is interpreted through registration or other means.

Quarantine—Confinement of a pet at a location designated by the Base Veterinarian.

Registration—The process of establishing medical records with Veterinary Services. Mandatory for dogs, cats, and rabbits. Any other animal may be registered if desired by owner.

Registrable animals—Normally, only dogs, cats, and rabbits are registrable. However, other animals may be specified "registrable" by the Installation Commander upon recommendation of the supporting Installation Veterinarian and 374 SFS.

Vicious Animal Behavior—Refers to more extreme aggressive behaviors usually consisting of, but not limited to, the following: 1) unprovoked attacks causing serious injury or death to a person or another animal, and 2) exhibited consistent pattern of aggressive behavior that threatens public safety.

Attachment 2

CARETAKER DESIGNATION FORM

A2.1. Caretaker Designation Form.

Your pet's medical records are protected by the privacy Act of 1974 and cannot be accessed by anyone without your permission.

If you are leaving your pet(s) in care of someone else while you are on leave, deployed, or TDY, you must present this form to the Yokota Veterinary Treatment Facility to be maintained in the record(s) in order for your pet(s) to receive medical care in your absence.

The caretaker must be a valid ID cardholder with SOFA status, at least 18 years old, and be able to pay for any rendered services at the Yokota Veterinary Treatment Facility.

Owner
Name:_____

Pet
Name(s):_____

Caretaker
Name:_____

Caretaker Phone Number
(Primary):_____

(Secondary):_____

Effective Date:_____ Expiration Date: _____

By signing, I agree that I am the sponsor and the owner of the pet(s) named above. I give authorization to the individual caretaker named above to receive medical care at the Yokota Veterinary Treatment Facility for my pet(s) in my absence. I have discussed with the designated caretaker my wishes/concerns regarding my pet(s) in the event of a life-threatening emergency.

I HAVE READ AND FULLY UNDERSTAND THIS CARETAKER DESIGNATION FORM:

Signature:_____
Date:_____